Curriculum Vitae

Dr. Melanie Viola Partsch

Personal Website | UU | MML Lab | Google Scholar | ResearchGate

Academic Education

03/2017-12/2022	Doctoral student at GESIS—Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences, Mannheim, Germany. **Dissertation** on "Methodological Challenges in the Assessment of Good Character" (Dr. phil., ***summa cum laude***, defended on November 10, 2023, at RPTU Kaiserslautern-Landau).
09/2013-10/2016	University of Mannheim, Germany—**M.Sc. Psychology** (final grade: 1,4) Master thesis at the Chair of Research Methods and Psychological Assessment
10/2010-09/2013	University of Ulm, Germany—**B.Sc. Psychology** (final grade: 1,4) Bachelor thesis at the Chair of Work and Organizational Psychology

Academic Work Experience

08/2023-	**Postdoctoral researcher** at Utrecht University, the Netherlands, at the Department of Methodology and Statistics, Faculty of Social and Behavioral Sciences
04/2026-	in the large-scale research infrastructure project "The Macroscope" funded by the Dutch Research Council (NWO).
02/2026-03/2026	as a **visiting researcher at University of Basel**, Switzerland, at the Department of Statistics and Data Science.
08/2023-01/2026	in the project "Detection and Classification of Misspecifications in Structural Equation Modeling Using Machine Learning" funded by the German Research Foundation (DFG).
01/2023-07/2023	Independent researcher (completion of my dissertation and other research projects)
03/2022-09/2022	**Research associate** at the University of Education Weingarten, Germany, at the Chair of Educational Psychology in the project "Contextual and Individual Determinants of Lifelong Learning" (conducted research and assisted in the preparation of a DFG grant proposal).
03/2017-12/2022	**Research associate** at GESIS—Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences, Mannheim, Germany, in the department Survey Design and Methodology
03/2022-12/2022	in the ***Questionnaire Design and Evaluation*** team (validated standard variables for selected sociodemographic characteristics in the third-party funded project KonsortSWD, part of the National Research Data Infrastructure NFDI).
03/2017-02/2022	in the ***Scale Development and Documentation*** team (e.g., developed scales for social surveys, reviewed submissions for the open-access scale repository ZIS and provided psychometric consulting, assisted in the maintenance and advancement of ZIS).

Academic Qualifications & Activities

Languages:	German (native), English (fluent), Dutch (intermediate), Swedish (basic), French (basic)
Software:	R (advanced), Mplus (intermediate), SPSS (intermediate), LaTeX (basic), HLM (basic)
Memberships:	*DGPs* (The German Psychological Society), *DPPD* (The Differential Psychology, Personality Psychology and Psychological Assessment Section of the DGPs)
Reviewing activities:	Educational and Psychological Measurement, European Journal of Psychological Assessment Journal of Personality Assessment, Journal of Survey Statistics and Methodology, Measurement Instruments for the Social Sciences, Psychological Test Adaptation and Development
Editorial service:	Associate editor at *mda (methods, data, analyses)*

Teaching & Supervision

Teaching:	***Advanced Research Methods and Statistics*** for Bachelor Psychology (teaching workgroups) ***Multilevel Analysis*** for various research Master programs, such as Educational Sciences (teaching computer labs, supporting the preparation of written exams, grading) ***Introduction to Structural Equation Modeling Using Mplus*** at Utrecht Summer School (teaching computer labs, consultation for individual research projects, supporting lectures) ***Methodology and Statistics Consultation*** for Bachelor and Master theses from students of the Faculty of Social and Behavioral Sciences
Supervision:	***Supervision of various Master theses*** within the Applied Data Science (ADS) program ***Supervision of various research internships*** at GESIS in the Scale Development and Documentation team

Workshops & Invited Talks

Partsch, M. V. (2026, March 12). *Why We Should Not Blindly Trust Fixed Cutoffs for Model Fit Indices—Insights From Interpretable Machine Learning* **[Invited Talk]**. Society & Choice Research Seminar, University of Basel, Switzerland.

Partsch, M. V., & Goretzko, D. (2025, September 21). *Established and Innovative Methods to Evaluate Model Fit in Structural Equation Modeling* **[Workshop]**. 18th Biennial Conference of the German Psychological Society - Personality Psychology and Psychological Diagnostics (DPPD) Section, University of Kassel, Germany.

Goretzko, D., **Partsch, M.V.**, & Sterner, P. (2025, July 22). *New Perspectives on Measurement Invariance Testing* **[Workshop]**. XI European Congress of Methodology (EAM 2025), University of La Laguna, Tenerife, Spain.

Partsch, M. V. (2024, November 9). *Detection and Classification of Misspecifications in Structural Equation Modeling Using Machine Learning* **[Invited Talk]**. Workshop of the German research training group Statistical Modeling in Psychology (SMIP), University of Mannheim, Germany.

Publications

Articles in Peer-Reviewed Journals

Partsch, M. V., & Goretzko, D. (2026). Detecting model misfit in structural equation modeling with machine learning—A proof of concept. *Multivariate Behavioral Research*, *61*(1), 1–24. https://doi.org/10.1080/00273171.2025.2552304

Goretzko, D., & **Partsch, M. V.** (2025). Predicting measurement model misfit with machine learning while accounting for nuisance parameters—An illustration. *Psychological Test Adaptation and Development*. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1027/2698-1866/a000111

Partsch, M. V., Sterner, P., & Goretzko, D. (2025). A simulation study on the interaction effects of underfactoring and nuisance parameters on model fit indices. *Structural Equation Modeling: A Multidisciplinary Journal, 32*(6), 1000–1015. https://doi.org/10.1080/10705511.2025.2514592

Goretzko, D., **Partsch, M. V.**, & Sterner, P. (2025). Embrace the heterogeneity in exploratory factor analysis but be transparent about what you do—A commentary on Manapat et al. (2023). *Psychological Methods*. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1037/met0000759

Schneider, S. L., Palm, L., & **Partsch, M. V.** (2025). CASMIN Versus ISCED: Validating standard education variables for German microdata. *KZfSS Kölner Zeitschrift Für Soziologie Und Sozialpsychologie, 77*(3), 445–477. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11577-025-01019-8

Partsch, M. V., Olaru, G., & Lechner, C. M. (2024). Measuring global character dimensions: An ant colony optimization approach toward three core strength scales. *Journal of Personality Assessment, 106*(5), 665–680. https://doi.org/10.1080/00223891.2024.2309994

Stanciu, A., **Partsch, M. V.**, & Lechner, C. M. (2024). Basic human values and the adoption of cryptocurrency. *Frontiers in Psychology*, *15*. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2024.1395674

Partsch, M. V., & Landberg, M. (2023). Modeling determinants of lifelong learning according to the Theory of Planned Behavior: A proxy-based approach using PIAAC data. *Adult Education Quarterly, 74*(2), 132—151. https://doi.org/10.1177/07417136231208951

Landberg, M., & **Partsch, M. V.** (2023). Perceptions on and attitudes towards lifelong learning in the educational system. *Social Sciences & Humanities Open, 8*(1), Article 100534. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ssaho.2023.100534

Partsch, M. V., Bluemke, M., & Lechner, C. M. (2022). Revisiting the hierarchical structure of the 24 VIA character strengths: Three global dimensions may suffice to capture their essence. *European Journal of Personality*, *36*(5), 825–845. https://doi.org/10.1177/08902070211017760

Partsch, M. V., & Danner, D. (2021). Measuring self-control in international large-scale surveys: Development and validation of a four-item scale in English, French, German, Japanese, Polish, and Spanish. *European Journal of Psychological Assessment*, *37*(5), 409–418. https://doi.org/10.1027/1015-5759/a000618

Lechner, C. M., **Partsch, M. V.**, Danner, D., & Rammstedt, B. (2019). Individual, situational, and cultural correlates of acquiescent responding: Towards a unified conceptual framework. *British Journal of Mathematical and Statistical Psychology*, *72*(3), 426–446. https://doi.org/10.1111/bmsp.12164

Nießen, D., **Partsch, M. V.**, Kemper, C. J., & Rammstedt, B. (2019). An English-language adaptation of the social desirability–gamma short scale (KSE-G). *Measurement Instruments for the Social Sciences*, *1*, Article 2. https://doi.org/10.1186/s42409-018-0005-1

Preprints (Under Review)

Partsch, M. V., & Goretzko, D. (2026). *A machine learning pipeline to classify the type and severity of misspecifications in latent measurement models*. PsyArXiv. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/84ftk_v2

Open-Access Survey Scale Documentations

Partsch, M. V., Schmidt, I., Haehner, P., & Lechner, C. M. (2023). *VaLiGo—Measuring basic human values and life goals with a nested 30–20–10-item inventory (German version)*. PsyArXiv. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/evr7a

Bluemke, M., **Partsch, M. V.**, Saucier, G., & Lechner, C. M. (2021). *Human character in the IPIP: Towards shorter, more content-valid, and cross-culturally comparable IPIP-VIA character strength scales*. PsyArXiv. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/k79qf

Partsch, M. V., Danner, D., & Chernyshenko, O. (2018). *CCS-based 7-item traditionalism scale (CCS-T-7)*. Zusammenstellung sozialwissenschaftlicher Items und Skalen (ZIS). https://doi.org/10.6102/ZIS261

Conference Presentations & Chaired Symposia

Partsch, M. V., & Goretzko, D. (2025, September 29–October 1). Introduction and illustration of a new method for detecting and classifying SEM misfit using machine learning. In **M. V. Partsch (Chair)**, *Measurement and Machine Learning* [Symposium]. 17th Conference of the Methods & Evaluation Section of the German Psychological Society (DGPs), Berlin, Germany.

Partsch, M. V., & Goretzko, D. (2025, July 23–25). A machine learning-based workflow for model evaluation and revision in SEM. In **M. V. Partsch (Chair)**, *Measurement and Machine Learning* [Symposium]. XI European Congress of Methodology (EAM 2025), San Cristobal de La Laguna, Tenerife, Spain.

Partsch, M. V., & Goretzko, D. (2024, September 16–19). Overcoming cutoffs in measurement model fit evaluation—a new machine learning-based approach. In D. Goretzko (Chair), *Investigating Measurement Invariance (MI) and Assessing Model Fit of Measurement Models* [Symposium]. 53rd DGPs Congress/15th ÖGP Conference, Vienna, Austria.

Partsch, M. V., Sterner, P., & Goretzko, D. (2024, July 16–19). Sensitivity of model fit indices in SEM to underfactoring. In D. Goretzko (Chair), *Advancements in structural equation modeling (SEM): Model fit, parameter selection, and measurement invariance* [Symposium]. 89th Annual Meeting of the Psychometric Society (IMPS), Prague, Czech Republic.

Partsch, M. V., Schmidt, I., Haehner, P., Hanzlová, R., & Lechner, C. M. (2023, September 24–27). VaLiGo—Measuring basic human values and life goals with a nested 30–20–10-item inventory. In B. Rammstedt (Chair), *Assessment of personality, attitudes, and other constructs* [Symposium]. 17th Biennial Conference of the German Psychological Society - Personality Psychology and Psychological Diagnostics (DPPD) Section, Salzburg, Austria.

Partsch, M. V., Bluemke, M., Olaru, G., & Lechner, C. M. (2021, September 12–15). Identifying and measuring three global dimensions of the VIA trait space based on the IPIP-VIA-R. In M. Bluemke & L. Wagner (Chairs), *How can we best describe and measure character in relation to personality?* [Symposium]. 16th Biennial Conference of the German Psychological Society - Personality Psychology and Psychological Diagnostics (DPPD) Section, Ulm, Germany.

Partsch, M. V., Bluemke, M., & Lechner, C. M. (2019, September 16–18). Applying the Bass-ackwards approach to the IPIP-VIA-R inventory to establish the higher-order structure of Peterson and Seligman's 24 character strengths. In M. Bluemke (Chair), *Solutions to methodological challenges in the equivalent assessment of personality traits and values* [Symposium]. 15th Biennial Conference of the German Psychological Society - Personality Psychology and Psychological Diagnostics (DPPD) Section, Dresden, Germany.

Partsch, M. V., Danner, D., & Rammstedt, B. (2018, September 15–20). Der inkrementelle Nutzen einer 30 Items umfassenden RIASEC-Kurzskala in kulturübergreifenden Bevölkerungsumfragen [The incremental value of a 30-item RIASEC short scale in cross-cultural large-scale assessment]. In M. Bluemke (Chair), *Fortschritte der Skalenentwicklung für internationale Vergleichsstudien (Large-Scale Assessment) [Progress in scale development for cross-national studies (large-scale assessment)]* [Symposium]. 51st congress of the German Psychological Society (DGPs), Frankfurt, Germany.

Partsch, M. V., Lechner, C. M., Bluemke, M., & Saucier, G. (2018, July 2–5). Character strengths: Towards a shorter (and more content-valid) measure of the IPIP-VIA scales. In D. Danner (Chair), *Advances in assessing non-cognitive skills in large-scale surveys* [Symposium]. 11th International Test Commission (ITC) Conference, Montréal, Canada.

Partsch, M. V., Danner, D., & Rammstedt, B. (2018, July 2–5). Vocational interests: The incremental value of a 30-item short scale suitable for large-scale assessment in six languages. In D. Danner (Chair), *Advances in assessing non-cognitive skills in large-scale surveys* [Symposium]. 11th International Test Commission (ITC) Conference, Montréal, Canada.

Partsch, M. V., Bluemke, M., Lechner, C. M., & Saucier, G. (2018, May 3–5). *Toward shorter (and more content-valid) measures of character strengths: Revising the IPIP-VIA scales* [Poster presentation]. 3rd conference of the German Society for Positive-Psychological Research (DGPPF), Bochum, Germany.

Partsch, M. V. (2017, September 4–6). *Facettentheoretische Entwicklung und Validierung einer Skala zu Personal Need for Structure [Applying facet theory to develop a Personal Need for Structure scale and its validation]* [Poster presentation]. 14th Biennial Conference of the German Psychological Society - Personality Psychology and Psychological Diagnostics (DPPD) Section, München, Germany.

Academic References

Prof. Dr. David Goretzko, Professor for Psychological Methods, Goethe University Frankfurt, goretzko@psych.uni-frankfurt.de

Prof. Dr. Mirka Henninger, Professor for Statistics & Data Science, University of Basel, mirka.henninger@unibas.ch

Dr. Gerard Saucier, Professor Emerit for Psychology (Cultural and Moral Personology), University of Oregon, gsaucier@uoregon.edu

Prof. Dr. Manfred Schmitt, Professor Emerit for Personality Psychology and Psychological Assessment, RPTU Kaiserslautern-Landau, Manfred.Schmitt@rptu.de